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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, US SENATOR DISCUSS REGIONAL ISSUES

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met United States Senator Joni Ernst in Abu Dhabi. During the meeting, they discussed strategic cooperation between the UAE and the United States and their shared commitment to further strengthening ties for the benefit of both nations. The talks also covered regional security and stability, and efforts to promote peace in the Middle East and beyond.

UAE reveals flydubai co-pilot tried to carry out terrorist act

Probe still on to establish motives, links, circumstances

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Counsellor Dr Hamad Saif Al Shamsi, UAE Federal Prosecutor, announced that investigations into the incident involving flydubai Flight FZ1073 revealed that the co-pilot had attempted to carry out a terrorist act.

He explained that the co-pilot began executing his plan during the flight by assaulting the pilot inside the cockpit us-

ing a crash axe and attempting to seize control of the aircraft's flight controls.

The Federal Prosecutor stressed that investigations are still under way to establish all the circumstances surrounding the incident, as well as the motives behind it and any associated links.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said the region's struggle against extremism is still ongoing, warning that rhetoric used to justify terrorism should itself be regarded as part of the threat.

In a post on X on Saturday, Gargash said the latest terror-

ist attack showed that the fight against extremism remained unfinished.

He stressed that attempts to justify terrorism through hate speech were not peripheral to the danger but formed part of it.

Meanwhile, Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, visited flydubai pilot Captain Smit Machchhar on Saturday, paying tribute to his courage, sense of responsibility and commitment to protecting human life.

SEE ALSO P4, 6, P-11

Gargash rejects Iran's criticism over UAE islands

UAE SEEKS PEACEFUL SETTLEMENT THROUGH TALKS OR WORLD COURT

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has rejected criticism by Iranian official Ali Akbar Velayati of the UAE's position on the islands of Abu Musa, Greater Tunb and Lesser Tunb, reaffirming Abu Dhabi's commitment to resolving the dispute peacefully.

In a post on X, Gargash said Velayati's criticism of the UAE's statement at the United Nations was "a political position" contradicted, in the UAE's view, by historical facts and documents supporting its claim. "Our approach is clear and consistent: Resolve the dispute peacefully through direct bilateral negotiations or recourse to the International Court of Justice," Gargash said.

Resolve and responsibility

The UAE would continue pursuing its legitimate rights "with resolve and responsibility" in accordance with international law, he added.

Velayati, a senior adviser to Iran's leadership, had rejected the UAE's claims after they were raised at the UN General Assembly, maintaining that the three islands belong to Iran.

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump said Washington would soon make a decision on Iran, warning that it would be resolved "the easy way or the



US President Donald Trump said Washington would soon make a decision on Iran, warning that it would be resolved 'the easy way or the hard way'.

hard way". "We have a decision that I'll make about Iran. Iran's been decimated. So the only question is, it'll either be the easy way or the hard way," Trump told reporters outside the White House. He gave no timeline or details of possible US action.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said his government had adopted a "new arrangement" to manage what he called special conditions as US economic pressure intensified. He accused Washington and other adversaries of waging an "economic war" aimed at cutting Iran's economic lifelines.

In Yemen, the Houthis claimed an attack on an Aramco site in Riyadh using ballistic missiles and drones.

Separately, five Indian nationals were brought safely ashore with Omani assistance after the Kuwait-flagged tanker MT Kazimah III was struck by a projectile in the Strait of Hormuz. The Indian Embassy in Oman said it coordinated with Omani authorities to evacuate the crew members safely.

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ABU DHABI



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